

NBA salary evidence for coaches

2022-23 NBA salary data | **466 players** | Guards 197 / Wings 91 / Bigs 178

What this study found

No single statistic met our evidence threshold.

We accounted for the other recorded inputs and checked 12 statistics across three position groups. The results do not establish that height, shooting, or other skills lack basketball value.

A practical example: height for bigs

One extra inch was associated with an estimated **8.1% higher NBA salary**, after adjusting for the other inputs.

95% uncertainty range: 4.6% lower to 22.4% higher salary.

The range includes no salary increase, so the direction remains uncertain. This does not justify an 8.1% height premium on a college offer.

How to use this in recruiting

- 1 Start a discussion.** Use model estimates to identify players and questions for film review, interviews, and scouting. Keep the assumptions visible.
- 2 Evaluate the whole role.** Points, minutes, shooting, and size overlap. An uncertain coefficient does not tell you a skill is unimportant for winning or for your roster.
- 3 Treat the dollars as rough estimates.** Dashboard prices use a separate NBA prediction model plus college pay settings. Check them against role, competition, scouting, and budget.

What the data cannot establish

This study describes one NBA season. Contracts also reflect past performance, expected potential, experience, and bargaining rules. It does not validate NCAA salaries or transfer to women's basketball.

METHOD AND SOURCES

Exploratory position-specific regression of log salary; 12 basketball inputs, age, and percentage availability. HC3 uncertainty; pointwise 95% intervals; Holm adjustment across 36 tests at 0.05. Source: supplied 2022-23 NBA salary workbook. Heights: current ESPN bios retrieved September 2026, not verified 2022-23 measurements.